

Introduction to English Literature

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A Course Description

- What to learn
- How to learn
- How to evaluate



What to Learn?

- Major genres: poetry, drama, novel
- Principle elements & Main features
- Critical theories
- How to analyze, appreciate and comment on literary works
- Texts to work on (**pre-reading required**):
 - “London” (William Blake)
 - “Sonnet 130” (William Shakespeare)
 - “I like to See it Lap the Miles” (Emily Dickinson)
 - “Soliloquy of the Spanish Cloister” (Robert Browning)
 - *A Midsummer Night’s Dream* (Shakespeare)
 - *Trifles* (Susan Glaspell)
 - *The Egg* (Sherwood Anderson)



How to Learn?

- Read: literary text, commentary
- Understand and memorize
- Put into practice



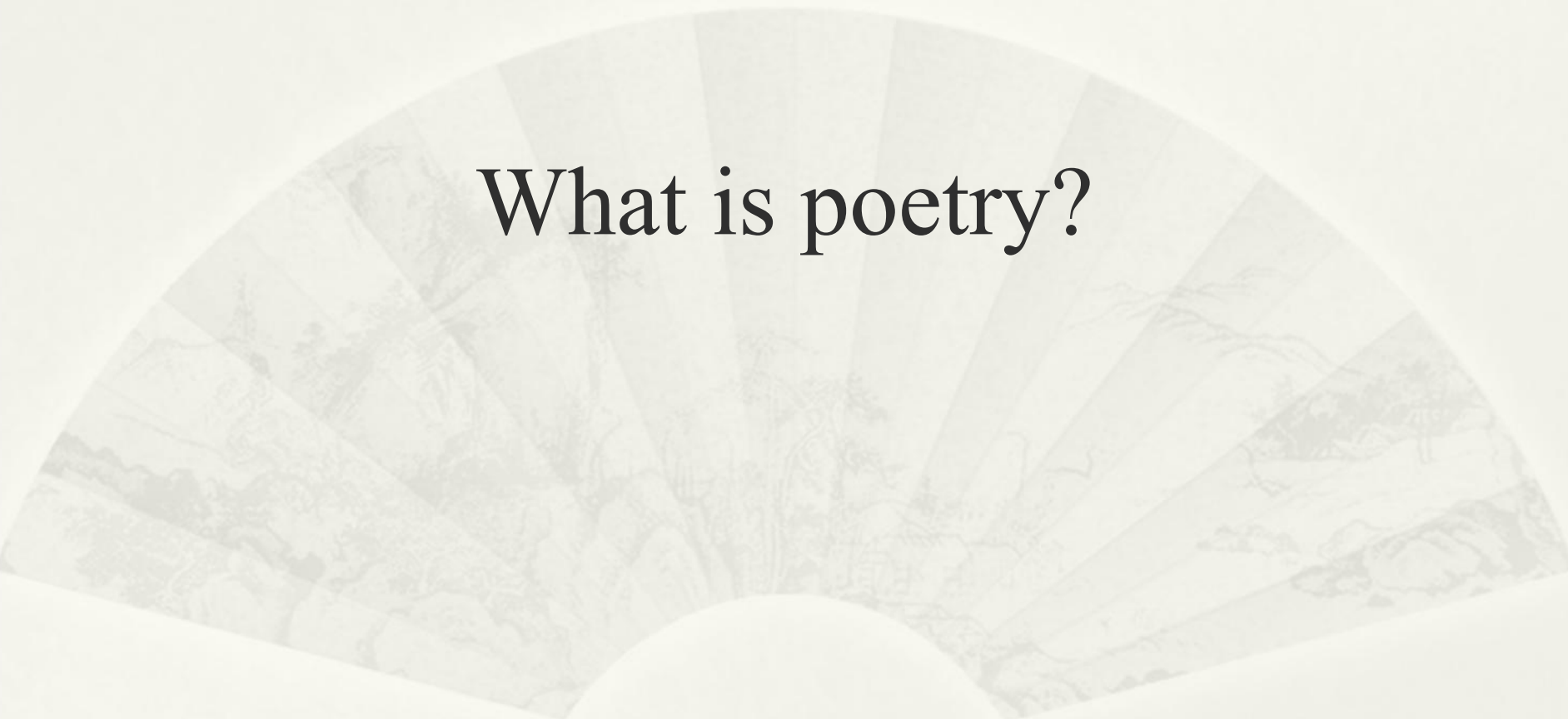
How to evaluate ?

- Written exam (70%)
 - common knowledge of literature
 - A short essay/commentary on literary works
- Mid-term assignment + Classroom participation (30%)



Part I. An Introduction to English Poetry

- * What is poetry?
- * Major types of poetry: narrative, lyric, dramatic
- * Major elements of poetry: voice (speaker and tone); diction; imagery; figure of speech; sound and rhythm
- * Focus:
 - * Prosody: sound and rhythm
 - * Imagery



What is poetry?

An example of Chinese prosody

白日依山尽，
黄河入海流。
欲穷千里目，
更上一层楼。

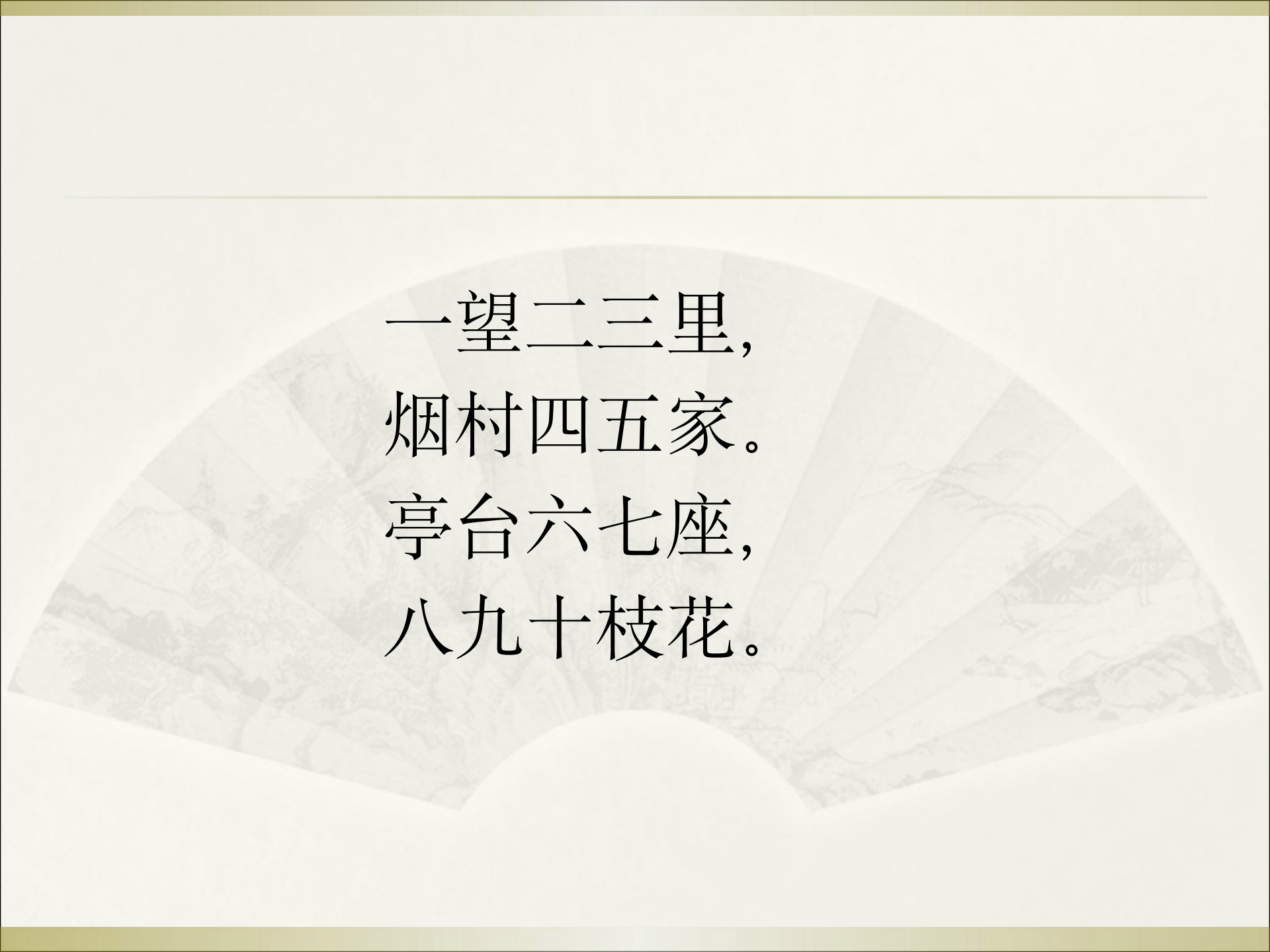
仄仄平平仄，
平平仄仄平。
平平平仄仄，
仄仄仄平平。

What makes a poem a
poem?

Rhyme?

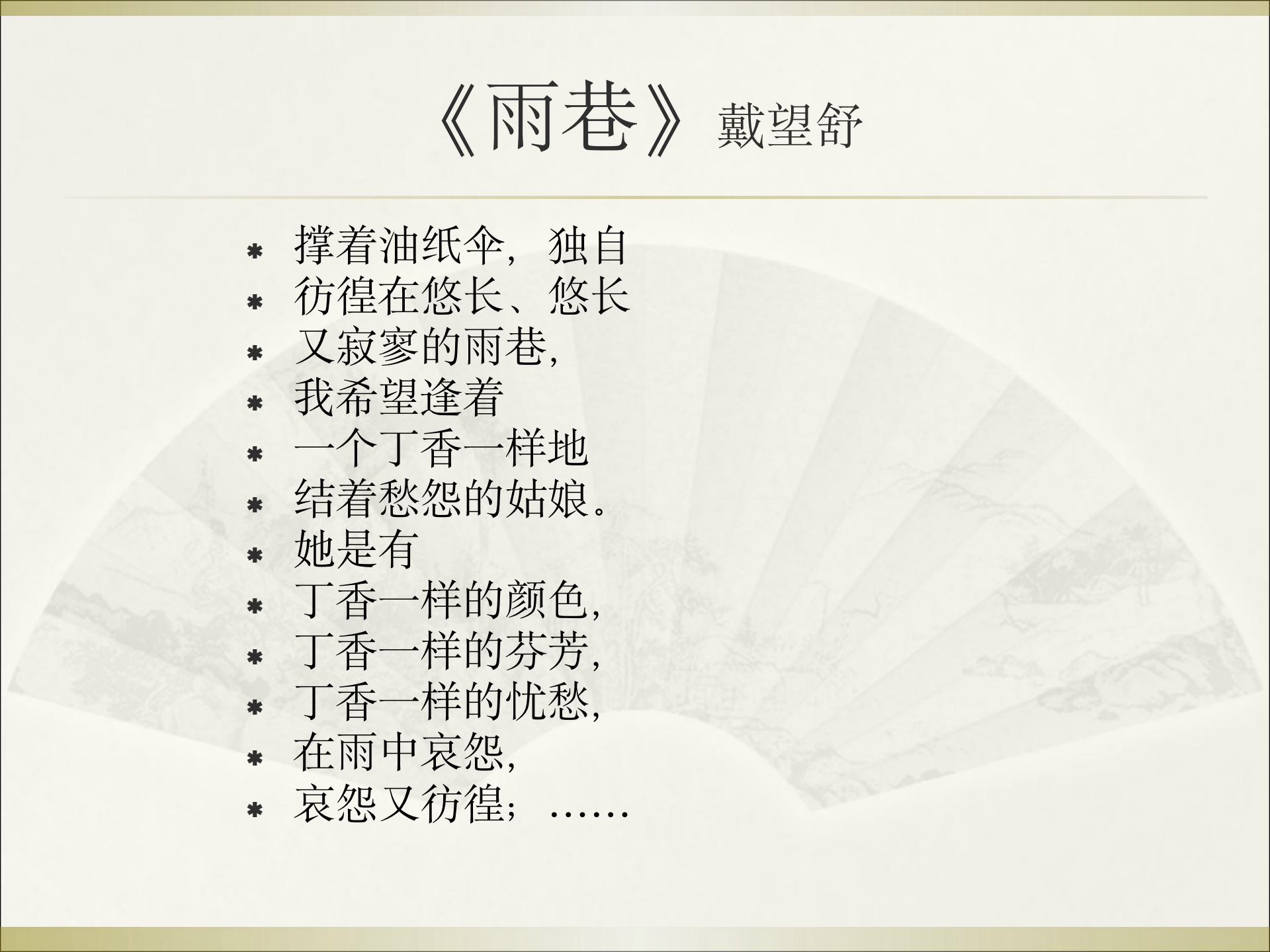
Refined language?

Metrical pattern?



一望二三里，
烟村四五家。
亭台六七座，
八九十枝花。

《雨巷》 戴望舒



* 撑着油纸伞，独自
* 彷徨在悠长、悠长
* 又寂寥的雨巷，
* 我希望逢着
* 一个丁香一样地
* 结着愁怨的姑娘。
* 她是有
* 丁香一样的颜色，
* 丁香一样的芬芳，
* 丁香一样的忧愁，
* 在雨中哀怨，
* 哀怨又彷徨；

-
- * Good poetry is “the spontaneous overflow of powerful feelings recollected in tranquility” (William Wordsworth)
 - * “If I read a book and it makes my body so cold no fire ever can warm me, I know that is poetry”. (Emily Dickinson)
 - * Poetry is “musical thought”. (Thomas Carlyle)
 - * “Hundreds of things coming together at

Poetry

- * As **metrical** writing (韵文) cf. **prose** (non-metrical writing, 非韵文)
- * **Poetry**: Composition in **verse or metrical language**, or in some equivalent **patterned arrangement of language**; usually also with choice of elevated words and figurative uses, and option of a symmetrical order, differing more or less from those of ordinary speech or prose writing. (OED)
- * 夫音律所始，本于人声者也。声含宫商，肇自血气，先王因之，以制乐歌。……故言语者，文章关键，神明枢机；吐纳律吕，唇吻而已。（南朝（梁）·刘勰《文心雕龙》）

The Lamb

William Blake

Little Lamb who made thee
Dost thou know who made thee
Gave thee life & bid thee feed.
By the stream & o'er the mead;
Gave thee clothing of delight,
Softest clothing wooly bright;
Gave thee such a tender voice,
Making all the vales rejoice!
Little Lamb who made thee
Dost thou know who made thee

English Prosody (作诗法)

* Formal Features of the English Poems:

① Stanza 诗节

② Rhyme 押韵

③ Metre 格律

(1) Stanza

Stanzaic form of poetry is
measured by the number of lines

List of stanza names

- 2–lines = Couplet (or distich ['distik]) 对句, 双行诗
- 3–lines = Tercet (['tə:sit]) (or triplet ['triplit]) 三行诗
- 4–lines = Quatrain (['kwɒtrein])
- 5–lines = Quintain (['kwintin]) (or cinquain [sin'kweɪn])
- 6–lines = Sextain (['sekstein])
- 7–lines = Septet (['sep'tet])
- 8–lines = Octave (['ɒkteɪv, -tɪv])
- 9–lines = Spenserian stanza 斯宾塞诗节
- 14–lines = sonnet

Couplet 双行诗

What dire offence from amorous causes springs,
What mighty contests rise from trivial things

(Alexander Pope, *the Rape of the Lock*)

Know then thyself, presume not God to scan,
The proper study of mankind is man.

(Alexander Pope, *An Essay on Criticism*)

Triplet 三行诗

Where is silk my Julia goes
Then, then (methink) how sweetly flows
That liquefaction of her clothes.

Next, when I cast mine eyes and see
That brave vibration each way free;
O how that glittering taketh me!

– R.Herrick, *The Poetry of Dress*

Tercet (Tercet rima) 三行体

- * Wild West Wind, thou breath of Autumn's being,
- * Thou, from whose unseen presence the leaves dead
- * Are driven, like ghosts from an enchanter fleeing,
- *
- * Yellow, and black, and pale, and hectic red,
- * Pestilence-stricken multitudes: O thou,
- * Who chariotest to their dark wintry bed
- *
- * The winged seeds, where they lie cold and low,
- * Each like a corpse within its grave, until
- * Thine azure sister of the Spring shall blow
- * Ode to the West Wind (P. B. Shelley)

Quatrain 四行诗

The Tyger

* by William Blake

* Tyger! Tyger! burning bright
In the forests of the night,
What immortal hand or eye
Could frame thy fearful symmetry?

Freedom and Love

T. Campbell

How delicious is the winning
Of a kiss at loves beginning,
When two mutual hearts are sighing
For the knot there's no untying

Yet remember, 'midst your wooing,
Love has bliss, but love has ruining;
Other smiles may make you fickle
Tears for other charm may trickle.

(quatrain, aabb aabb)

Cinquain 五行诗

To a Skylark

BY P.B. Shelley

Hail to thee, blithe spirit!
Bird thou never wert —
That from heaven, or near it
Pourest thy full heart
In profuse strains of unpremeditated art.

Higher still and higher
From the earth thou springest,
Like a cloud of fire,
The blue deep thou wingest,
And singing still dost soar, and soaring ever singest.

(Cinquain: ababb, The rhyme scheme could also be: abccb or abcbb)

Sextain 六行诗

The Moon

Shelley

And like a dying lady lean and pale,
Who totters forth, wrapp'd in a gauzy veil
Out of her chamber, led by the insane
And feeble wanderings of her fading brain,
The moon arose up in the murky east
A white and shapeless mass

(Sextain: aabbcd. The rhyme scheme could also be aabbcc; aaabba;
ababcd)

Septet 七行诗

Rape of Lucrece

William Shakespeare

When they had sworn to this advised doom,
They did conclude to bear dead Lucrece thence
To show her bleeding body thorough Rome,
And so to publish Tarquin's foul offence:
Which being done with speedy diligence,
The Romans plausibly did five consent
To Tarquin's everlasting banishment.

(Septet in strict Rhyme Royal : ababbcc)

Enjambement 跨行连续

- * **Enjambement**: The process, where poetic argument runs over the line end or sequence of line-endings without pause or punctuation.

- * Run-on line cf. end-stopped line

E.g.

- * The world was all before them, where to choose
- * Their place of rest, with Providence their guide;
- * They hand in hand with wandering steps and slow
- * Through Eden took their solitary way.

* ---John Milton's *Paradise Lost*

(2) Rhyme 押韵

- Rhyme: the formalized consonance of syllables
- Rhyme Scheme 韵式

2.1 The Degrees of Rhyme

* **Vowel Rhymes** 元音韵

- * **1. Full rhyme** (or “perfect rhyme”/ “exact rhyme”) 全韵
 - * e.g. fish/dish, smiling/filing; why/sigh; power/flower; ending/bending; away/today
- * **2. Assonance** 谐元韵 (腹韵)
 - * e.g. shake/hate; time/ mind; sweet/dream; light/vine; holy/smoke
- * **3. Reverse rhyme** 倒尾韵
 - * great/grazed; student/studio; sell/send; soul/sold; painting/patience
- * A boy's **will** is the **wind**'s will 少年的愿望好似风的愿望

* **Consonant Rhymes 辅音韵** (or slant rhyme, near rhyme, imperfect rhyme)

* **1. Alliteration (head rhyme) 头韵**

* e.g. lord of language; safe and sound; fish or fowl

* Five *m*iles *m*eandering with a *m*azy *m*otion
(Coleridge, *Kubla Khan*)

* **2. Consonance 谐辅韵 (辅音韵, 假韵)**

* e.g. fish/dash, smiling/falling, cold/bald; hot foot

* **3. Para-rhyme 副韵 (类尾韵)**

* e.g. rabies/robbers, block/black, reader/rider,
despise/dispose; creak/croak

* **Eye rhyme 眼韵**

* e.g. blood/hood; there/here; daughter/laughter

2.2 The Types of Rhyme

- * **Masculine rhyme 男韵**

e.g. smile/file, design/resign

O could I flow like thee, and make thy stream
My great example, as it is my theme!

Though deep, yet clear, though gentle, yet not dull,
Strong without rage, without o'erflowing full.

John Denham, “Cooper’s Hill”

- * **Feminine rhyme 女韵**

e.g. smiling/filing, designing/resigning, picky/tricky

- * Once upon a midnight dreary,

- * while I pondered, weak and weary,

- * Over many a quaint and curious volume of forgotten lore

- * Edgar Allan Poe, “The Raven”

2.3 The position of rhyme

- * **End rhyme (尾韵)** : when rhyming words appears at the end of lines
- * **Internal rhyme (行中韵)**: when rhyming words appears in the middle (or rhyming between the word preceding the caesura ([si:ˈzjuərə]停顿) and the end-word)
 - * I met a *man* with a skin of *tan*
 - * His only *cloak* it was the *smoke*

Rhyme schemes (韵式) = stanza + rhyme

• list of rhyme schemes:

- **Heroic couplet** 英雄体双行诗, 英雄偶句诗: *aa bb, cc, etc.*
- **Ballad** 民谣体: *abcb*, or *abab*.
- **Terza rima** 三行体, 三叠韵: ([ˈtɛə:tʃəˈri:mə]) first used by the Italian poet Dante Alighieri (1265 – 1321). *aba bcb cdc ...*
- **Ottava rima** 八行体: ([əˈtɑ:vəˈri:mə]) Italian origin. *abababcc*.
- **Spenserian stanza** 斯宾塞式诗节 (九行) : *ababbcbcc*.
- **Sonnet** 十四行诗
 - **Petrarchan sonnet**: 彼得拉克十四行诗 ([piˈtrɑ:kən]) or Italian sonnet. *abbaabba cdccdc*.
 - **Shakespearean sonnet** 莎士比亚十四行诗 or English sonnet. *abab cdcd efef gg*.
 - **Spenserian sonnet** 斯宾塞十四行诗: *abab, bcbc, cdcd, ee*.

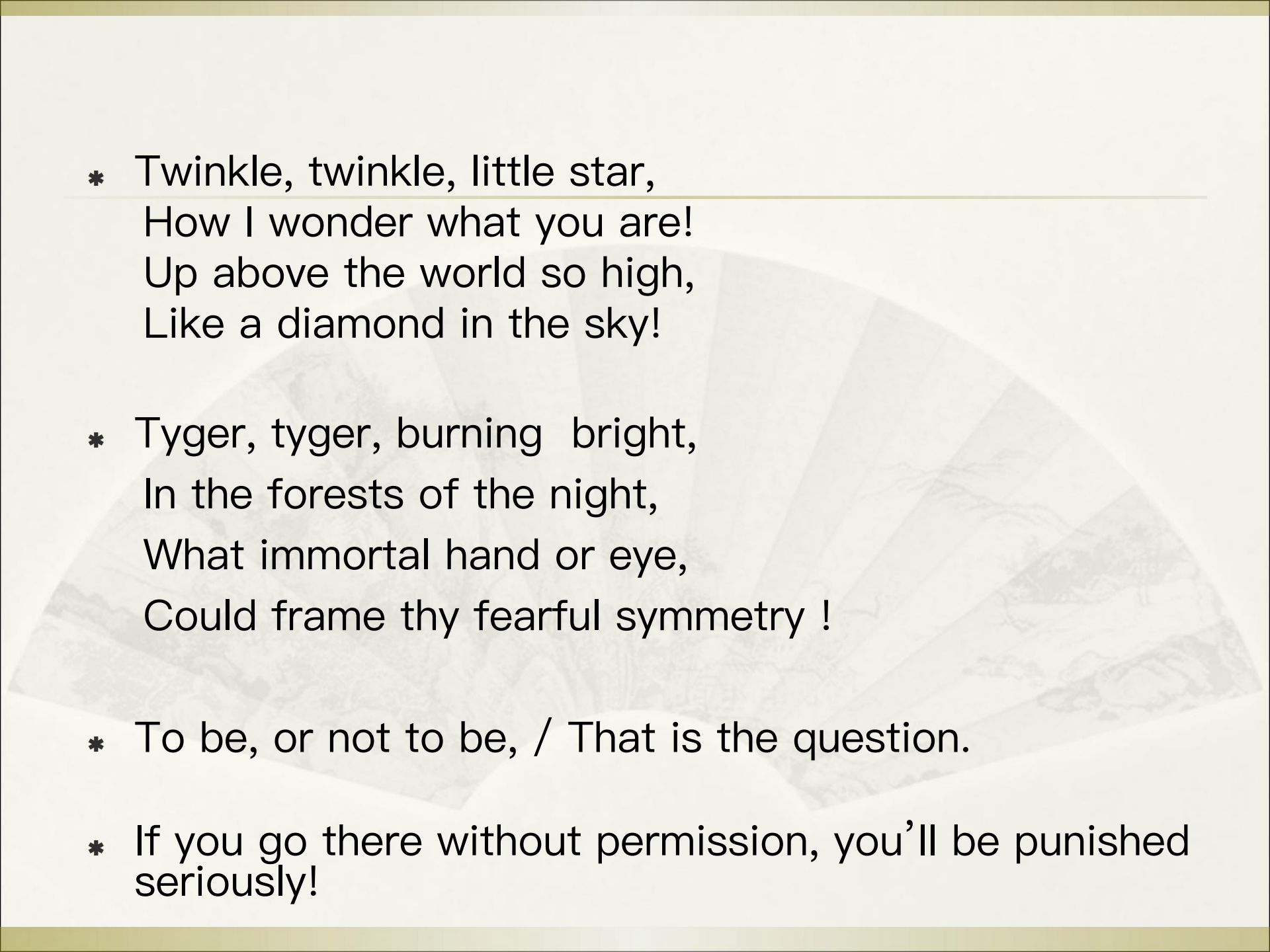
Ode to the West Wind

P. B. Shelley

- * Wild West Wind, thou breath of Autumn's being,
- * Thou, from whose unseen presence the leaves dead
- * Are driven, like ghosts from an enchanter fleeing,
- *
- * Yellow, and black, and pale, and hectic red,
- * Pestilence–stricken multitudes: O thou,
- * Who chariotest to their dark wintry bed
- *
- * The winged seeds, where they lie cold and low,
- * Each like a corpse within its grave, until
- * Thine azure sister of the Spring shall blow

(3). Meter and Rhythm

格律与节奏

- 
- * Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are!
Up above the world so high,
Like a diamond in the sky!
 - * Tyger, tyger, burning bright,
In the forests of the night,
What immortal hand or eye,
Could frame thy fearful symmetry !
 - * To be, or not to be, / That is the question.
 - * If you go there without permission, you'll be punished seriously!

Rhythm ← Meter ← Foot ← Syllable

- * Character of **Syllables** (音节): stressed or unstressed
- * **Foot** (音步): the basic unit in the description of the underlying rhythm of a poem. It is described by the character and number of **syllables** it contains.
- * **Meter** (格律) (the recurring pattern of stress and pause in a line): the discernible metrical pattern of a poem. It is described by the type as well as the number of **foot** in a line.

' x ' x ' x '

Tyger, / tyger, /burning / bright

' x ' x ' x '

In the/forests/ of the / night

3.1 the Types of Foot

1. iamb ("iambus", adj. iambic 抑扬格/短长音 (× ')

*lambus in words and idioms: today, compare, consist, defeat,

*lambus in idioms and daily expressions:

- * through thick and thin, from A to Z, see eye to eye
- * It's time the children went to bed.
- * We'll learn a poem by Keats today.

*lambus in poems:

* × | × | × | × | × |

To wake / the soul / by ten / der strokes / of art,

$\times$ ' $\times$ ' $\times$ ' $\times$ ' $\times$ '

To raise / the ge /nius, and / to mend / the heart.

--- Pope' s *Prologue* to Addison' s *Cato*

2. Trochee (adj. trochaic 扬抑格/长短音 (' ×)

*English, college, Cambridge.

*Twinkle, twinkle, little star,

*How I wonder what you are!

*Up above the world so high,

*Like a diamond in the sky!

*Land of hope and glory, Mother of the Free,

How shall we extol thee, who are born of thee?

— A. C. Benson

3. Dactyl (adj. dactylic) 扬抑抑格(' × ×) ['dæktɪl]

e.g. actually, negative, influence, demonstrate, poetry

Ace in the hole, under the weather; Actions speak louder than words

Cannon to right of them
Cannon to left of them
Cannon in front of them
Volleyed and thundered
Stormed at with shot and shell,
Boldly they rode and well
Into the jaws of death
Into the mouth of hell,
Rode the six hundred.

— Alfred Tennyson's (1809–1892) 'The Charge of the Light

Brigade'

4. Anapaest (adj. anapestic) 抑抑扬格

(× × ') ([' æ n ə p i : s t])

*interrupt, understand, contradict,

*in the blink of an eye, in the still of the night

* × × ' × × ' × × ' × × '

We may roam | through this world, | like a child | at a feast,

× × ' × × ' × × ' × × '

Who but sips | of a sweet, | and then flies | to the rest;

List of the **types** of foot

- **iamb**: 抑扬格 ([ˈaɪæmb]) one unstressed syllable + a stressed syllable
- **trochee** 扬抑格: ([ˈtrəʊki:]) one stressed syllable + an unstressed syllable
- **dactyl** 扬抑抑格: ([ˈdæktɪl]) one stressed syllable + two unstressed syllables
- **anapest** 抑抑扬格: ([ˈænəpi:st]) two unstressed syllables + one stressed syllable
- **spondee** 扬扬格: ([ˈspɒndi:]) two stressed syllables
- **pyrrhic** 抑抑格: ([ˈpɪrɪk]) two unstressed syllables

List of the **number** of feet in a line:

- * **monometer** (单音步): one foot
- * **dimeter**: ([ˈdɪmɪtə]双音步) two feet
- * **trimeter**: ([ˈtrɪmɪtə]三音步) three feet
- * **tetrameter**: ([teˈtræmɪtə]) four feet
- * **pentameter**: ([penˈtæmɪtə]) five feet
- * **hexameter**: ([hekˈsæmɪtə]) six feet (the six-foot iambic hexameter is called Alexandrine)
- * **heptameter**: ([hepˈtæmɪtə]) seven feet
- * **octameter**: ([ɒkˈtæmɪtə]) eight feet

3.2 Meter (格律)

- * Described by both the **type** and the **number** of the predominating foot.

x ' x ' ' x x ' x '

Shall I compare **thee** to a summer's day?

- * **iambic pentameter** (抑扬格五音步): a meter comprising five feet per line, in which the predominant kind of foot is the "iambus"

x ' x ' x ' x ' x '

To wake | the soul | by ten | der strokes | of art,

x ' x ' x ' x ' x '

To raise | the ge|nius, and | to mend | the heart.

--- *Prologue* to Addison's *Cato*, by A. Pope

x ' x ' ' x x ' x '

Shall I compare **thee** to a summer's day?

' x x ' x ' x x

Thou art more lovely and more temperate

* **Trochaic tetrameter** (扬抑格四音步)

' x ' x ' x '

Tyger, / tyger, /burning / bright

' x ' x ' x '

In the/forests/ of the / night

' x ' x ' x '

What immortal hand or eye

x ' x ' x ' x '

Could frame thy fearful symmetry

-- William Blake' s *Tyger*
mixed metre

Exercises: identify the metrical pattern of the following lines:

- * Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
- * How I wonder what you are!
* (Trochaic tetrameter)

- * We may roam through this world, like a child at a feast,
- * Who but sips of a sweet, and then flies to the rest;
* (Anapest tetrameter)

- * Land of hope and glory, Mother of the Free,
How shall we extol thee, who are born of thee?
* (Trochaic hexameter)

Metric variation

* A violation of / deviation from the expected metrical pattern: for the purpose of stressing or emphasizing; or simply to avoid being mechanical and monotonous

1. ***Inversion***: e.g. to turn an iambus into a trochee.

Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?/ **Thou** art more lovely and more temperate

1. ***Omission***

◆ ***headless verse***: lacking the first syllable of the first foot.

The time you won your town the race
We chaired you through the market-place;
Man and boy stood cheering by,
And home we brought you shoulder-high.

◆ ***catalexis***: the end of a line is shortened by a foot, or two or part thereof

I see a lily on thy brow,
With anguish moist and fever-dew,
And on thy cheeks a fading rose
Fast withereth too.

Ex 1. p. 139

“London” by W. Blake

I wan/der thro' /each char/ter'd
street,
Near where /the char/ter'd
Thames/ does flow.
And mark /in e/very face/ I meet
Marks /of weak/ness, marks/ of
woe.

In e/very cry /of e/very Man,
In e/very In/fants cry /of fear,
In e/very voice: /in e/very ban,
The mind/-forg'd ma/nacles /I
hear

How /the Chim/ney –swee/pers cry
E/very black/ning Church/ appalls,
And/ the hap/less Sol/diers sigh
Runs /in blood/ down Pa/lace walls

But most/ thro' mid/night streets/ I
hear

How/ the youth/ful Har/lots curse
Blasts/ the new/-born In/fants tear

And blights/ with plagues/ the
Ma/rriage hearse

Ex. 2 p. 147
Sonnet 130

- * *My mistress' eyes are nothing like the sun;
Coral is far more red than her lips' red;
If snow be white, **why** then her breasts are dun;
If hairs be wires, **black** wires **grow** on her head.
I have seen roses damask'd, red and white,
But no such roses see **I** in her cheeks;
And in some perfumes is there more delight
Than in the breath that from my mistress reeks.
I love to hear her speak, yet well I know
That music hath a far more pleasing sound;
I grant I never saw a goddess go;
My mistress, when she walks, **treads** on the ground:
And yet, by heaven, I think my love as rare
As any she belied with false compare.*

Some other popular verse forms

- * Blank verse (素体诗): Unrhyming iambic pentameter, also called heroic verse. (unrhyme, but with the metrical pattern of iambic pentameter)
 - * E.g. Shakespeare's *Hamlet*, *Romeo and Juliet*, John Milton's *Paradise Lost*
- * Free verse (自由诗): written in lines, could be rhymed or unrhymed, but without metrical patterns
 - * E.g. Walt Whitman's *Leaves of Grass* and many modern poets' poems

江南可采莲

江南可采莲，莲叶何田田！鱼戏莲叶间。
鱼戏莲叶东，鱼戏莲叶西，鱼戏莲叶南，
鱼戏莲叶北。

——乐府民歌

The **art** of the orator is never to allow
artificiality to become noticeable.

---Nietzsche, “Ancient Rhetoric”

朱光潜的诗歌三要素

我以为诗的要素有三种：就骨子里说，它要表现一种**情趣**；就表面说，它有意象，有声音。我们可以说，诗以情趣为主，情趣见于**声音**，寓于**意象**。”（朱光潜《诗论》（三联书店，1984年））

* 天净沙 秋思 马致远

- * 枯藤老树昏鸦，小桥流水人家，古道西风瘦马。
- * 夕阳西下，断肠人在天涯。

相见欢 李煜

- * 无言独上西楼，月如钩。寂寞梧桐深院锁清秋。
- * 剪不断，理还乱，是离愁。别是一番滋味在心头。

* 声声慢 李清照

- * 梧桐更兼细雨，到黄昏、点点滴滴。

* 江雪 柳宗元

- * 千山鸟飞绝，万径人踪灭
- * 孤舟蓑笠翁，独钓寒江雪。

Imagery

- * **Imagery**: representation through language of **sense experience** (sight, sound, smell, taste, touch, internal sensation, motion, etc.)
- * Communicates not information, but experience
 - * Not to tell, but to **show**
 - * With concrete and image-bearing expressions
- * Feature: suggestive, provoking
- * Function:
 - * Association of images,
 - * Invocation of imagination,
 - * Creation of connotation and meaning
- * Purpose: to evoke vivid experience and convey feelings and ideas

In a Station of the Metro

by Ezra Pound (1855 —1972)

- * The apparition of these faces in the crowd;
Petals on a wet, black bough.
- * 人群里忽隐忽现的张张面庞，
黝黑沾湿枝头的点点花瓣。（裘小龙）

Japanese Haiku 日本俳句

* Taniguchi Buson (Yosa Buson)

- * 1. The piercing chill I feel
- * My dead wife's comb, in our bedroom
- * under my heel...

- * 2. Standing still at dusk
- * listen . . . In far
- * distances
- * The song of froglings!

言意之辩&言象意

- * 子曰：书不尽言，言不尽意。
- * 子曰：圣人立象以尽意，设卦以尽情伪。
 - * 《周易 系辞上》
- * 言生于象，象生于意 (how it is created by the author)
- * 意以象尽，象以言著 (the effect of the text)
- * (得意在忘象，得象在忘言) (the reader)
 - * 《周易略例 明象篇》
 - * 王弼 (三国时期魏国玄学家)

创造是表现情趣于意象，可以说是**情趣的意象化**；**欣赏**是因意象而见情趣，可以说是**意象的情趣化**。美就是情趣意象化或意象情趣化，是心中所觉到的“恰好”的快感。

--- 朱光潜 《什么叫做美》

Diction

- * Poetry is the art of language.
- * Properties of language:
 - * Sound
 - * Denotation: literal meaning
 - * Connotation: overtone of meaning (depending on associations, allusion, implication, context)
- * Language in poetry vs. language in daily expressions and in science

Language in poetry:

- * short and concise;
- * **concrete** instead of abstract;
- * **aesthetic** value (not informative)
- * **suggestive and multidimensional**, aiming for the effect of **ambiguity** and **increment of meaning** instead of directness, precision or exactness; / 诗无达诂
 - * *Seven types of Ambiguity* (William Empson)
- * **novelty** — sometimes even **shock of surprise** — instead of automaticity, direct conveyance of information.
 - * Defamiliarization and alienation (Formalism) 陌生化

* 登高 (杜甫)

风急天高猿啸哀，渚清沙白鸟飞回。
无边落木萧萧下，不尽长江滚滚来。
万里悲秋常作客，百年多病独登台。
艰难苦恨繁霜鬓，潦倒新停浊酒杯。

寻寻觅觅，冷冷清清，凄凄惨惨戚戚

——（《声声慢》李清照）

* 锦瑟 (李商隐)

锦瑟无端五十弦，一弦一柱思华年。
庄生晓梦迷蝴蝶，望帝春心托杜鹃。
沧海月明珠有泪，蓝田日暖玉生烟。
此情可待成追忆，只是当时已惘然。

- * 夏也荷过了/秋也蝉过了/今日适逢小雪（洛夫）
- * 云飘在水中/帆飞在天上（冰夫《莲塘月》）
- * 潮湿的鸟声还沾在睫毛（采莲子）
- * 根须扎进《诗经》/伸出一枝枝唐诗/一叶叶宋词/
柔风的唇轻吟/押声声柳韵依依（伊德超《折柳》）

Figures of Speech

- * Figure forth things: Help render the poetry visual and pictorial, concrete and specific, by creating images.
- * Major types:
 - * Metaphors and similes e.g. sunset of life;
 - * Metonyms 转喻 e.g. Man has to sweat to earn his bread. The pen is mightier than the sword. From the cradle to the grave.
 - * Synecdoche 提喻 e.g. They share the same roof. Outside, there's a sea of faces.
 - * Irony /understatement /overstatement
 - * Paradox 悖论修辞 e.g. Less is more.
 - * Oxymoron 矛盾修辞法 e.g. living dead , peace force , a clever fool , true lies
 - * Pun e.g. Truth over flies. (the fly that stopped on Pence's hair for more than 2 minutes during the Vice-President debate.) Claudius: "... But now, my cousin Hamlet, and my son..." Hamlet: [aside] "A little more than *kin*, and less than *kind*." (*Hamlet*)
 - * Personification

Every use of figurative language
involves a risk of misinterpretation.

**But it's a risk rewarding and
always worth taking.**

Exercise 2:

- * Make an analysis of the imagery, figurative usage and diction in “London”. Pay special attention to how the images contribute to the expression and conveyance of themes.
- * In “London”, what images are involved in the description of London? How are these images presented? What impressions have they left about London?
- * What are the rhetorical devices employed?

Ex 2. p. 139 “London” (1794) by W. Blake

I wander thro' each **charter'd**
street,
Near where the **charter'd**
Thames does flow.
And **mark** in every face I meet
Marks of weakness, **marks** of
woe.

In **every** cry of **every** Man,
In **every** Infants cry of fear,
In **every** voice: in **every** ban,
The mind–forg'd manacles I
hear

How the Chimney–sweepers **cry**
Every blackning Church appalls,
And the hapless Soldiers **sigh**
Runs in blood down Palace
walls

But most thro' midnight streets I
hear
How the youthful Harlots **curse**
Blasts the new–born Infants
tear
And blights with plagues the
Marriage hearse

Voice: Speaker and Tone

- * **poet** cf. **speaker** in the poem
- * Cf. **author** cf. **narrator** of the novel
- * **Speaker:** reliable speaker; unreliable speaker
 - * Reliable speaker in the poem: the attitude of the speaker represents, to a large extent, that of the poet's
 - * Unreliable speaker: the attitude of the speaker is different from that of the poet's, as very often in the dramatic monologues
- * **Tone:** emotional coloring or meaning; what makes the attitude of the poem clear to the readers.
 - * affectionate, solemn, gloomy, nostalgic, calm, passionate, hostile, sarcastic, ironic, etc.
 - * The use of meters and rhyme, word choice, syntactic structure, figurative expression, imagery... all these elements contribute to produce the tone.

* 卜算子 · 咏梅 宋 陆游

- * 驿外断桥边，寂寞开无主。已是黄昏独自愁，更着风和雨。
- * 无意苦争春，一任群芳妒。零落成泥碾作尘，只有香如故。

* 卜算子· 咏梅 毛泽东

- * 风雨送春归，飞雪迎春到。已是悬崖百丈冰，犹有花枝俏。
- * 俏也不争春，只把春来报。待到山花烂漫时，她在丛中笑。

Try to analyze the speaker and the tone in Sonnet 130

- * *My mistress' eyes are nothing like the sun;
Coral is far more red than her lips' red;
If snow be white, why then her breasts are dun;
If hairs be wires, black wires grow on her head.
I have seen roses damask'd, red and white,
But no such roses see I in her cheeks;
And in some perfumes is there more delight
Than in the breath that from my mistress reeks.
I love to hear her speak, yet well I know
That music hath a far more pleasing sound;
I grant I never saw a goddess go;
My mistress, when she walks, treads on the ground:
And yet, by heaven, I think my love as rare
As any she belied with false compare.*

Questions to ponder upon while reading “I like to see it lap the Miles”

- * A riddle-like poem which describes the Amherst and Belcher Town Railway Station and a train that's coming down the tracks:
 1. What aspects of “it” have been described? What qualities of “it” are demonstrated in these descriptions?
 2. What figurative devices are employed?
 3. What is Dickinson's attitude towards “it” which is implied in the diction of the poem?

I like to see it lap the Miles

by Emily Dickinson (1831–1886) p.157

- * I like to see it lap the Miles –
- * And lick the Valleys up –
- * And stop to feed itself at Tanks –
- * And then – **prodigious** step
- * Around a Pile of Mountains –
- * And **supercilious** peer
- * In Shanties – by the sides of Roads –
- * And then a Quarry pare
- * To fit its sides
- * And crawl between
- * **Complaining** all the while
- * In **horrid** – hooting stanza –
- * Then chase itself down Hill –
- * And neigh like **Boanerges** –
- * Then — punctual than a Star
- * Stop – **docile and omnipotent**
- * At it's own stable door –

Classification of Poetry

Narrative

- Epic
- Ballad
- Romance

Lyric

- Epigram
- Elegy
- Ode
- Aubade
- Sestina
- Sonnet
- Villanelle

Dramatic

- Dramatic monologue
- Dramatic soliloquy

- * **Epic**: a lengthy narrative poem in elevated stature and ceremonious style, usually concerning a serious subject containing details of heroic deeds and events significant to a culture or nation. E.g. *Iliad* and *Odyssey*, *Beowulf*
- * **Ballad**: a folk song or orally transmitted poem telling some popular story in a simple dramatic way. E.g. Robin Hood ballads (侠盗罗宾汉) -- for the people
- * **Romance** (medieval chivalry romance): a type of narrative poem mainly concerned with knightly adventure, popular during the Middle Ages and the Renaissance. The chief characters are human beings who often confront monsters, dragons, and disguised animals, e.g. *Sir Gawain and the Green Knight* 《高文爵士和绿衣骑士》 -- (for the nobles and feudal aristocracy)

- ❖ **Ode** : a lyric poem that uses lofty, dignified language to address a person or thing, an elaborately structured poem praising or glorifying an event or individual, describing nature intellectually as well as emotionally. E.g. Ode to the West Wind (Shelley); Ode to the Grecian Urn (Keats)
- ❖ **Elegy**: a lyric poem lamenting a dead friend, or a public figure. E.g. Shelley's "Adonais" (lamenting Keats' death); W. Whitman's "When Lilacs Last in the Dooryard Bloom'd" (on the death of A. Lincoln)

Dramatic Monologues

- * **Dramatic monologue:** a type of **poetry** written in the form of a speech of an individual character, a single persona who speaks to an implied auditor and is “overheard” by the reader.
- * The reader has no authorial comment to shape his or her interpretation of the characters or their circumstances.
- * The speaker inadvertently “gives away” about himself in the process of rationalizing past actions, or “special pleading” his case to a silent auditor, or a self–defense which the addressee, as “juror”, is challenged to judge.

- * 3 features (M. H. Abrams):

- * The single **person**, who is patently *not* the poet, utters the speech in a specific **situation** at a critical moment.
- * The auditors' presence, and what they say and do, are known only from clues in the discourse of the single speaker.
- * The main principle is to reveal to the reader, in a way that enhances its interest, the speaker's temperament and character.

- * Robert Browning (1812–1889)

- * **Dramatic monologue**: My Last Duchess (1842)
- * **Dramatic soliloquy**: Soliloquy of the Spanish Cloister

Elements in a Dramatic Dialogue

- * Scene (time and space/location)
- * Characters:
 - * A speaker (persona)
 - * An addressee (auditor)
- * Events (plots)
- * Language
- * Theme

Soliloquy of the Spanish Cloister

by Robert Browning

* I.

Gr-r-r--there go, my heart's **abhorrence!**

Water your damned flower-pots, do!

If hate killed men, Brother Lawrence,
God's blood, would not mine kill you!

What? your myrtle-bush wants trimming?

Oh, that rose has prior claims--

Needs its leaden vase filled brimming?

Hell dry you up with its flames!

-
- * II.
 - * At the meal we sit together;
 - * *Salve tibi!* I must hear
 - * Wise talk of the kind of weather,
 - * Sort of season, time of year:
 - * *Not a plenteous cork crop: scarcely*
 - * *Dare we hope oak-galls, I doubt,*
 - * *What's the Latin name for "parsley"?*
 - * What's the Greek name for "swine's snout"?

* III

- * Whew! We'll have our platter burnished,
- * Laid with care on our own shelf!
- * With a fire-new spoon we're furnished,
- * And a goblet for ourself,
- * Rinsed like something sacrificial
- * Ere 'tis fit to touch our chaps—
- * Marked with L. for our initial!
- * (He—he! There his lily snaps!)

-
- * IV.
 - * *Saint, forsooth!* While Brown Dolores
 - * Squats outside the Convent bank
 - * With Sanchicha, telling stories,
 - * Steeping tresses in the tank,
 - * Blue-black, lustrous, thick like horsehairs,
 - * —Can't I see his dead eye glow,
 - * Bright as 'twere a Barbary corsair's?
 - * (That is, if he'd let it show!)

-
- * V.
 - * When he finishes refection,
 - * Knife and fork he never lays
 - * Cross-wise, to my recollection,
 - * As do I, in Jesu's praise.
 - * I the Trinity illustrate,
 - * Drinking watered orange pulp—
 - * In three sips the Arian frustrate;
 - * While he drains his at one gulp!

* VI.

Oh, those melons? If he's able
We're to have a feast! so nice!
One goes to the Abbot's table,
All of us get each a slice.

How go on your flowers? None double
Not one fruit-sort can you spy?
Strange!--And I, too, at such trouble,
Keep them close-nipped on the sly!

-
- * VII.
 - * There's a great text in Galatians,
 - * Once you trip on it, entails
 - * Twenty-nine district damnations,
 - * One sure, if another fails;
 - * If I trip him just a-dying,
 - * Sure of heaven as sure can be,
 - * Spin him round and send him flying
 - * Off to hell, a Manichee?

-
- * VIII.
 - * Or, my scrofulous French novel
 - * On grey paper with blunt type!
 - * Simply glance at it, you grovel
 - * Hand and foot in Belial's gripe;
 - * If I double down its pages
 - * At the woeful sixteenth print,
 - * When he gathers his greengages,
 - * Ope a sieve and slip it in't?

-
- * IX.
Or, there's Satan!—one might venture
 - * Pledge one's soul to him, yet leave
 - * Such a flaw in the indenture
 - * As he'd miss till, past retrieve,
 - * Blasted lay that rose-acacia
 - * We're so proud of! Hy, Zy, Hine...
 - * *'St, there's Vespers! Plena gratia*
 - * *Ave, Virgo!* Gr-r-r—you swine!

Form and Language

- * Nine eight-line stanzas, each rhyming *ABABCD CD*
- * The lines fall roughly into trochaic tetrameter, although with some irregularities.
- * Follows the conventions of spoken language:
 - * nonverbal sounds (“Gr–r–r–”) and
 - * colloquial language (“Hell dry you up with its flames!”)

Subject matter and Scene in “Soliloquy of the Spanish Cloister”

- * Place: an anonymous monastery
- * The monk’s interior commentary
- * Subject matter:
 - * the grumblings of a jealous monk, presenting himself as the model of righteousness. The speaker condemns a fellow monk, Brother Lawrence, for his immorality; but we soon recognize that the faults he assigns to Lawrence are in fact his own.

-
- * The poem explores moral hypocrisy and immorality: behind righteousness often lurks self-righteousness and corruption.
 - * The speaker levels some rather malevolent curses at Brother Lawrence, accusing his fellow monk of gluttony and lechery, when it is obvious, based on the examples he gives, that it is the speaker himself who is guilty of these sins.
 - * The speaker's fantasies about trapping Lawrence into damnation suggest that Lawrence is in fact a good man who will